

Class 9 English - Kaveri

Poem 2: Gifts of Grace: Honouring Our Vocations

Detailed, Exam-Oriented Poetry Solutions

Poem	Gifts of Grace: Honouring Our Vocations
Textbook	Kaveri - Class 9 English
Type	Poem / Free Verse
Focus	Dignity of labour, diversity of vocations, identity and contribution to society
Vocations mentioned	Craftspersons, artisans, carpenters, electricians, boatmen, shoemakers, cooks, designers and masons

1. Poem Information

The poem celebrates the many occupations through which people contribute to the life of Bharat. Instead of treating one profession as more valuable than another, the speaker notices the skills, sounds, products and services associated with different workers. The poem therefore presents work as a source of dignity and identity.

Form: The poem is written in free verse. It does not follow a fixed rhyme scheme. Its varying line lengths allow the poet to move naturally from one vocation to another.

Speaker: The speaker appears to be an observer who listens to and celebrates the varied vocations of the people of Bharat.

Tone: Reverential and joyful. The speaker expresses admiration and respect for workers and their skills.

Mood: Celebratory, warm and appreciative.

2. Section-wise Explanation

Opening - Bharat and its varied vocations

The speaker says that he hears Bharat celebrating its varied vocations. The phrase suggests that the country is alive with the sounds and activities of people at work. Craftspersons and artisans are appreciated for what they create. Their colourful crafts and music bring variety and richness to public life.

Carpenters and electricians

The carpenters create objects from wood with mathematical precision. Their work combines creativity with accuracy. The electricians work with cables and wires to brighten people's lives. Their humming suggests energy, familiarity and satisfaction in their work.

Boatmen and shoemakers

The boatmen are associated with song and movement. Their voices become part of the cultural soundscape. The shoemakers take pride in the quality of their work because their shoes support feet that walk, dance, run, jump and return home. Their craft therefore serves ordinary as well as joyful human activities.

Cooks, designers and masons

The cook's work is presented almost like delicious music because food gives pleasure and nourishment. Designers and masons contribute through their own specialised skills. Each worker celebrates something

that belongs uniquely to their vocation.

Work and identity

The poem connects vocation with identity. A person's skill speaks through the work he or she creates. The repeated celebration of different occupations shows that society depends on many forms of knowledge and labour.

Ending - continued celebration

The poem returns to the idea of Bharat celebrating varied vocations. This repetition reinforces the idea that every honest occupation deserves recognition and that the diversity of work is an important part of the country's social and cultural life.

3. Important Vocabulary

Word	Meaning
vocation	a profession or occupation, especially one requiring a particular skill
craftsperson	a person skilled in making things by hand
artisan	a skilled craft worker
myriad	a very large or countless number
hailing	greeting, praising or acknowledging
precision	great accuracy
affirm	state or declare firmly and confidently
rhythm	a regular pattern of movement or sound
varied	different from one another
vibrancy	energy, colour and liveliness
contribution	something given or done to help others
identity	the qualities that make a person or group recognisable

4. Poetic Devices

Device	Explanation	Example / Effect
Alliteration	Repetition of initial consonant sounds.	"varied vocations"; "carpenters celebrating"
Personification	A non-human idea is presented as capable of human action.	"Bharat celebrating" and the celebration associated with vocations
Imagery	Words create sensory pictures of work, sound, movement and colour.	"woven with colours and myriad hues"; "humming"; "singing"; "rhythm"
Metaphor	One thing is described in terms of another to convey an idea.	"The voice of their vocation is the voice of their identity."
Repetition	A word or phrase is repeated for emphasis.	The recurring idea of "Bharat celebrating" and varied vocations
Enjambment	A sentence or idea continues beyond the end of a line.	Several lines flow into the next without a full stop, creating a conversational movement.
Free Verse	Poetry without a fixed rhyme scheme or regular metrical pattern.	The poem uses varying line lengths and natural speech-like rhythm.

5. Important Lines and Their Significance

"I hear Bharat celebrating, the varied vocations I hear;"

Significance: The speaker imagines the whole country as a living celebration of different kinds of work. It establishes the poem's appreciative attitude towards labour.

“Those of craftsperson, each one celebrating their craft, woven with colours and myriad hues.”

Significance: The line celebrates handmade skill and the beauty produced by craftspersons. The words create colourful visual imagery.

“The carpenters celebrating; they create anything out of wood with mathematical precision,”

Significance: Carpentry is shown as both creative and technical. Precision is essential to successful craftsmanship.

“The electricians humming; they get ready for work, work with cables and wires to brighten our lives,”

Significance: Electricians perform an essential service. Their work literally helps provide light and symbolically makes life brighter.

“The shoemakers affirming the quality of their work, for the feet that walk, dance, run, jump, return home.”

Significance: Good footwear supports almost every kind of movement. The line highlights the practical value of skilled work.

“each celebrating what belongs to them and to none else,”

Significance: Every occupation has its own special skill and contribution. No worker's craft is identical to another's.

“The voice of their vocation is the voice of their identity.”

Significance: This connects profession and identity. A person's work expresses skill, individuality and social contribution.

6. NCERT Textbook Solutions - Reflect and Respond

Q. Riddle: In furrows deep, secrets I sow, as time passes, I watch them grow. Who am I?

Answer: A farmer.

Q. Riddle: From wheel to kiln, my skill is born, step by step, an art takes form. Who am I?

Answer: A pot maker or potter.

Q. Riddle: I lay foundations, brick by brick, to build a house, it's me you pick. Who am I?

Answer: A mason or builder.

Q. Riddle: I work with pots, pans, and spice, creating dishes that taste so nice. Who am I?

Answer: A cook or chef.

Q. What is the role and relevance of the people identified in the riddles? How do they contribute to society?

Answer: Farmers produce food and raw materials; potters create useful vessels; masons build houses and other structures; and cooks prepare food. Their work meets basic human needs and supports the functioning of society. These occupations also represent practical knowledge and skills that have developed over generations.

7. Understanding and Appreciation of the Poem

Q. Does the poem strictly adhere to a rhyme scheme, or is it in free verse?

Answer: The poem is written in free verse. It does not follow a fixed rhyme scheme or regular metrical pattern. This gives the speaker freedom to describe different occupations in a natural, conversational way.

Q. What is the impact of the varying length of lines in the poem?

Answer: The varying line lengths create a natural flow and allow different occupations to receive the amount of description they need. Longer lines provide details, while shorter portions create emphasis. The changing rhythm also reflects the diversity of occupations being celebrated.

Q. What is the pattern in the structure of most lines?

Answer: Many lines introduce a worker or vocation and then describe the work performed and its effect or contribution. This repeated pattern gives the poem unity while allowing each occupation to remain distinct.

Q. Who appears to be the speaker and what is their role?

Answer: The speaker appears to be an observer who notices and appreciates the work of different people. The speaker acts as a celebrant of their skills and contributions and invites readers to look at ordinary occupations with respect.

Q. What is the tone and mood of the poem?

Answer: The tone is reverential and joyful because the speaker admires the workers and their skills. The mood is celebratory, warm and appreciative, reflecting the richness created by diverse occupations.

8. Critical Reflection - Complete Solutions

Q. The poet says that the shoemakers 'affirm' the quality of their work. What does 'affirm' mean here?

Answer: It means to declare with confidence. The shoemakers confidently stand by the quality of the footwear they create.

Q. What do quality shoes help with, according to the poet?

Answer: Quality shoes support the feet in many activities: walking, dancing, running, jumping and returning home. Thus, the work of shoemakers supports both everyday necessities and joyful experiences.

Q. What does 'return home' symbolise besides the literal act of returning?

Answer: It suggests safety, belonging, comfort and connection with one's roots. Home represents a place where a person feels secure and accepted.

Q. Identify the phrase that tells us that every worker's contribution is distinct.

Answer: The phrase "each celebrating what belongs to them and to none else" shows that every worker has a unique skill and contribution.

Q. Complete: 'for the feet that walk, dance, run, jump, return home' refers to ____.

Answer: It refers to the many movements and activities of everyday human life that depend on the support provided by footwear.

Q. Why does the poet say, 'I hear Bharat celebrating, the varied vocations I hear'?

Answer: The speaker hears the sounds associated with different kinds of work and imagines them together as a celebration. The line acknowledges the contribution of workers across Bharat and presents the diversity of occupations as something worthy of appreciation.

Q. What does the electrician's humming while getting ready for work suggest?

Answer: It suggests energy, familiarity and a positive relationship with work. The electrician is shown as someone who approaches the occupation as a meaningful part of daily life.

Q. Explain the significance of 'The voice of their vocation is the voice of their identity.'

Answer: The line means that a person's work expresses who they are, what they know and what they contribute. The skill visible in the work becomes a recognisable part of the worker's identity.

Q. Do you think the role of people belonging to different vocations is important in daily life?

Answer: Yes. Modern life depends on interconnected occupations. Farmers provide food, masons construct buildings, electricians provide essential electrical services, cooks prepare food, shoemakers provide footwear and many other workers meet different human needs. Society functions smoothly because these contributions work together.

Q. Why is the poet celebrating all the vocations?

Answer: The poet celebrates them because honest work has dignity and every occupation contributes something necessary or valuable. By naming different workers, the poem encourages readers to respect skills rather than judge occupations only by status or income.

9. Vocabulary in Context

Q. A person who studies or grows garden plants is called a ____.

Answer: Horticulturist.

Q. A trained female community health worker is called an ____.

Answer: ASHA worker (Accredited Social Health Activist).

Q. A producer of raw silk is called a ____.

Answer: Sericulturist.

Q. A person whose job is making or selling sweets and chocolates is a ____.

Answer: Confectioner.

Q. A metalworker who specialises in precious metals is a ____.

Answer: Goldsmith.

Q. A person who fuses materials together is a ____.

Answer: Welder.

10. Listening Activity - Answer Key

The listening activity presents a boy and a girl discussing their parents' occupations.

1. What does the boy use to understand the details of the tools? — He goes through his father's tool kit.
2. The girl is ____ about taking food for her mother at the factory. — Happy.
3. The boy thinks the job of the girl's mother carries a lot of _____. — Responsibility.
4. The girl ____ why the boy is good at science exhibitions. — Realises.

11. Extract-Based Questions

Extract

I hear Bharat celebrating, the varied vocations I hear;

Those of craftsperson, each one celebrating their craft, woven with colours and myriad hues.

The artisans with lutes, each hailing varied emotions and celebrating dreams, echoing in the streets.

Q. What does 'Bharat celebrating' suggest?

Answer: It suggests that the country recognises and celebrates the many kinds of work performed by its people.

Q. What does 'myriad hues' mean?

Answer: It means countless colours or shades.

Q. What are lutes?

Answer: They are stringed musical instruments.

Q. How does this extract create imagery?

Answer: It appeals especially to sight through colours and to hearing through music and echoes in the streets.

Extract

The carpenters celebrating; they create anything out of wood with mathematical precision,

The electricians humming; they get ready for work, work with cables and wires to brighten our lives,

Q. What quality of carpenters is highlighted?

Answer: Their precision and ability to shape wood creatively.

Q. What do electricians work with?

Answer: Cables and wires.

Q. Why is the word 'brighten' significant?

Answer: Electricians literally provide electrical lighting, while 'brighten' also suggests improving the quality of people's lives.

Q. Identify one poetic device in 'carpenters celebrating'.

Answer: Alliteration through the repeated initial 'c' sound.

Extract

The shoemakers affirming the quality of their work, for the feet that walk, dance, run, jump, return home.

The delicious singing of the cook, or the rhythm of designer, mason, each celebrating what belongs to them and to none else,

Q. What does 'affirming' mean?

Answer: Declaring confidently or firmly.

Q. What activities are associated with the feet?

Answer: Walking, dancing, running, jumping and returning home.

Q. What does the cook's 'delicious singing' suggest?

Answer: It compares the pleasure of good food with the beauty of music.

Q. What does 'none else' emphasise?

Answer: It emphasises the uniqueness of each worker's skill and contribution.

12. Very Short Answer Questions

Q. What is a vocation?

Answer: A profession or occupation requiring particular work or skill.

Q. What does the poem celebrate?

Answer: The varied vocations and the people who perform them.

Q. Who creates things from wood with mathematical precision?

Answer: Carpenters.

Q. Who works with cables and wires?

Answer: Electricians.

Q. Who is associated with boats and singing?

Answer: Boatmen.

Q. Who ensures the quality of footwear?

Answer: Shoemakers.

Q. What is the form of the poem?

Answer: Free verse.

Q. What is the tone of the poem?

Answer: Reverential and joyful.

Q. What does a vocation represent besides a job?

Answer: It represents skill, dignity of labour, service and identity.

Q. What does 'myriad' mean?

Answer: Countless or very many.

13. Short Answer Questions

Q. How does the poem establish dignity of labour?

Answer: The poem names a range of ordinary occupations and describes each with admiration. Carpenters, electricians, boatmen, shoemakers, cooks, designers and masons are not presented as background figures; their skills are actively celebrated. This makes clear that useful and skilled work deserves respect.

Q. How does the poem celebrate diversity?

Answer: The poem moves from one occupation to another, showing different skills, tools, sounds and products. The variety itself becomes a source of richness. Each vocation is unique, yet all contribute to the life of Bharat.

Q. Explain the relationship between vocation and identity.

Answer: A person's vocation reflects their training, skill and contribution. The poem says that the 'voice' of a vocation is also the worker's identity, suggesting that work can communicate who a person is and what they are capable of creating or providing.

Q. Why is free verse suitable for this poem?

Answer: The poem celebrates variety, so a rigid rhyme scheme could have imposed unnecessary uniformity. Free verse allows line lengths, rhythm and descriptions to change naturally as the speaker moves from one occupation to another.

Q. What is the significance of sensory imagery in the poem?

Answer: The poem uses sounds, colours, movement and taste-related images. We hear humming, singing and lutes; we see colours and crafts; we imagine walking and dancing; and we associate cooking with deliciousness. These details make the workers' contributions vivid and memorable.

14. Long Answer / Analytical Questions

Q. "The poem is a celebration of ordinary people and extraordinary skills." Discuss.

Answer: The poem draws attention to people whose daily work often becomes invisible because it is part of ordinary life. Yet each occupation requires knowledge and skill. Carpenters need precision, electricians understand cables and wires, shoemakers ensure quality footwear, cooks transform ingredients into nourishing food, and masons build structures. By describing these workers with admiration, the speaker changes the reader's perspective: everyday labour is shown as valuable craftsmanship. The poem therefore celebrates not only the products of work but also the skill, discipline and human effort behind them.

Q. How does the poem connect individual occupations with the larger life of Bharat?

Answer: The poem does not isolate workers from society. Instead, their work is shown as part of the living soundscape of Bharat. Crafts bring colour, musicians create emotion, electricians brighten homes, shoemakers support movement, cooks provide food, and masons build structures. Each vocation serves a need while also contributing to the cultural richness of the country. The repeated idea of Bharat celebrating these occupations suggests that national life is created through the combined efforts of many kinds of workers.

Q. Explain the significance of the title 'Gifts of Grace: Honouring Our Vocations'.

Answer: The title presents occupations as gifts because skilled work benefits others and adds value to society. 'Grace' suggests something worthy of appreciation, while 'honouring' indicates respect. The word 'vocations' broadens the poem beyond a single profession. The title therefore prepares the reader to see work not merely as a means of earning money but as a source of dignity, service, identity and social contribution.

Q. What message does the poem convey about judging occupations?

Answer: The poem encourages readers to respect occupations for their skill and contribution rather than ranking them according to social prestige. It gives space to different workers and describes their work positively. The message is that every honest vocation can possess dignity and that society depends on the combined contribution of many people.

15. Value-Based Questions

Q. Why should students respect workers whose jobs are often taken for granted?

Answer: Many services that appear ordinary are essential to daily life. Respecting workers helps students understand the effort behind the facilities and products they use. It also promotes humility, gratitude and social responsibility.

Q. How can schools promote dignity of labour?

Answer: Schools can expose students to different occupations, invite skilled workers to speak about their work, organise vocational activities and ensure that support staff are treated respectfully. Students can also learn that practical skills and academic skills are complementary.

Q. Is a person's occupation enough to define their whole identity? Discuss.

Answer: Occupation is an important part of identity because it reflects skill and contribution, but it is not the only part. A person also has family roles, values, interests, relationships and personal qualities. The poem emphasises vocation as a powerful expression of identity without requiring it to be the complete definition of a person.

16. Additional Important Questions

Q. List the vocations mentioned in the poem.

Answer: Craftspersons, artisans, carpenters, electricians, boatmen, shoemakers, cooks, designers and masons.

Q. Why are carpenters associated with mathematical precision?

Answer: Because successful carpentry requires accurate measurement, proportion, cutting and fitting.

Q. How do electricians 'brighten our lives'?

Answer: Their work provides electrical connections and lighting, making homes and other spaces functional and safe.

Q. Why are shoemakers' contributions especially connected with movement?

Answer: Because footwear supports the feet during walking, running, dancing and jumping.

Q. Why is the cook's work described through singing?

Answer: The expression makes food preparation seem creative and harmonious, like music.

Q. What does the phrase 'to none else' suggest?

Answer: It suggests that each worker's craft is distinctive and personally associated with that worker.

Q. How does repetition contribute to the poem?

Answer: It reinforces the idea that the celebration of occupations is broad, continuous and inclusive.

Q. What kind of mood is created by the poem?

Answer: A joyful, respectful and celebratory mood.

17. MCQs

No.	Question	Ans.
1	The poem is primarily about: A. Nature B. War C. Vocations and dignity of labour D. Travel	C
2	The poem is written mainly in: A. Sonnet form B. Free verse C. Ballad form D. Haiku	B
3	Who works with wood with mathematical precision? A. Boatmen B. Carpenters C. Cooks D. Masons	B
4	Who works with cables and wires? A. Electricians B. Designers C. Shoemakers D. Farmers	A
5	The word 'myriad' means: A. very few B. countless C. useless D. difficult	B
6	What does 'affirm' mean in the poem? A. deny B. declare confidently C. forget D. repair	B
7	The title mainly conveys: A. criticism of work B. respect for occupations C. dislike of cities D. fear of machines	B
8	Which occupation is NOT mentioned in the poem? A. Carpenter B. Electrician C. Boatman D. Pilot	D
9	The phrase 'voice of their vocation' connects vocation with: A. weather B. identity C. wealth alone D. age	B
10	Which poetic device is present in 'varied vocations'? A. Alliteration B. Simile C. Irony D. Oxymoron	A
11	The mood of the poem is mainly: A. hostile B. celebratory C. tragic D. fearful	B
12	The poem uses colours and hues mainly to create: A. auditory imagery B. visual imagery C. irony D. suspense	B
13	What do shoemakers affirm? A. The price of shoes B. The quality of their work C. The weather D. Their education	B

No	Question	Ans.
14	What do the shoemakers' products support? A. Only running B. Only dancing C. Many kinds of movement D. Only working	C
15	The poem suggests that every vocation: A. is identical B. has a unique contribution C. is easy D. should be abandoned	B
16	The speaker's attitude towards workers is: A. disrespectful B. indifferent C. admiring D. hostile	C
17	The 'lutes' are: A. tools for carpentry B. stringed musical instruments C. cooking vessels D. electrical devices	B
18	The poem's varying line lengths help create: A. a natural conversational flow B. a fixed rhyme C. a strict metre D. a comic effect only	A
19	Which word best describes the poem's tone? A. Reverential B. Angry C. Sarcastic D. Suspicious	A
20	The poem finally encourages readers to: A. rank occupations B. ignore skilled workers C. honour diverse vocations D. avoid traditional work	C

18. Exam-Oriented Answer-Writing Tips

- In extract questions, first identify the worker/vocation and then explain the relevant phrase.
- For 2–3 mark questions, write a direct answer followed by one supporting detail from the poem.
- In long answers, mention at least three different vocations as textual evidence.
- Remember the key vocabulary: vocation, craftsman, artisan, myriad, precision, affirm, identity.
- Remember the key poetic features: free verse, alliteration, personification, imagery, repetition and metaphor.